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The Encyclopaedia Britannica 2010 marks the last print edition, after 244 years
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The new iPad is here!

New iPad in India Apple's new iPad tablet is available in India via online retailer Tradus, at ₹36,799 for the 16GB Wi-Fi variant. <http://dgit.in/GI2VEg>

Mobile watch

Vodafone, Timbre Media re-introduce WorldSpace radio service in India

Vodafone India has partnered with Timbre Media to provide WorldSpace Radio services on mobile handsets across 18 circles in India. The new service includes access to thousands of songs via 10 radio channels. The WorldSpace Radio service on Vodafone will be available in circles namely Uttar Pradesh East & West, Rajasthan, Haryana, Punjab, Mumbai, Bihar, Kerala, rest of Bengal, Assam, North East, Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh,

Jammu & Kashmir, Orissa, Delhi, Tamil Nadu and Chennai.

Co-founder and head of Timbre Media, Seetal Iyer said that the new services don't compete with the local FM stations or their mobile services. Iyer further pointed out that WorldSpace Radio specialises in genre-based radio programming. The WorldSpace on Vodafone has 10 stations that provide music from different genres, ranging from old Hindi films to regional folk songs.

To activate this service, Vodafone customers can call 58000

(toll free) or SMS ACT Wradio to 111 (toll free) or USSD on *514*580#. Users will be charged a rental of ₹30 per month along with 300 minutes of free usage.

Vodafone also provides a top-up of ₹7 through which users can get additional 70 minutes of listening time, once the free 300 minutes are over. The operator also plans to launch a separate service, which will be based on data streaming and priced at ₹5 per day.

Timbre Media, on the other hand, is looking to partner with

other telecom operators as well and plans to bring out a dedicated mobile app for smartphone users.

It may be recalled that Bangalore-based start-up Timbre Media had acquired the licence to use the WorldSpace brand, that went off air in December 2009. WorldSpace now faces stiff competition from the major FM players such as Radio Mirchi and Big FM, which are also targeting the mobile phones with their apps. Radio Mirchi's Mirchi mobile app has some 8-10 million subscribers. 

Wishtel launches two "Ira" Android budget tablets, starting at ₹4,000

Wishtel India has launched two tablets in the Indian market, the Ira Thing and the Ira, priced at ₹4,000 and ₹5,500 respectively, plus tax.

The specifications of both the budget tablets are the same apart from the fact that the Ira Thing has a resistive touchscreen and the Ira has a capacitive touchscreen. The battery of both the devices too is different. The Ira Thing has a 2,200 mAh battery whereas the Ira has a 2,800 mAh battery.

The devices on display at a press event ran Android 2.2 Froyo but the manufacturers confirmed that the device will launch with Gingerbread. Apart from Android, customers will have the option of using the tablet on the Linux Sugar OS.



Speaking at the event, Milind Shah, CEO, Wishtel, said: "This launch is the first

step in our long-term vision of bringing people closer to technology by creating gadgets that truly touch their lives. By enabling support for Indian languages, we're providing the opportunity for hundreds of millions of Indians to join the tablet revolution that is sweeping the globe today. We also hope to reach out to those brilliant minds in India that are inhibited for the lack of proper resources."

Richard Brown, VP International Marketing, VIA Technologies, Inc., added: "With the introduction of the IRA and IRA Thing, Wishtel is leading the way in driving tablet innovation in India. The potential for these devices is breathtaking, particularly in areas such as education." From the specifications of

the device and its build, it's clear that Wishtel is aiming to take on the Aakash and the Aakash 2 tablet manufactured by Datawind.

Specifications of Wishtel Ira Thing i-Pad and Ira i-Pad

- 7-inch touchscreen with a resolution of 800x480
- 800MHz CPU
- 512 MB RAM
- Android 2.2/2.3
- 4GB inbuilt storage expandable up to 32GB via MicroSD card
- Wi-Fi
- The device has a USB 2.0 port to which users can connect a 3G dongle
- Card reader
- Headphones jack
- 1.3MP front-facing camera and no rear shooter
- 20.3 x 13.7 x 1.45 cm
- 0.37 kg 